

Intel, Nokia to create futuristic mobile devices

Further integrating the Internet with mobile phones and computers, Intel and Nokia have announced a long-term relationship to develop a new class of Intel-based mobile computing device and chipset architecture. This is slated to combine the performance of powerful computers with high-bandwidth mobile broadband communications and ubiquitous Internet connectivity.

To realise this shared vision, both companies are expanding their long-standing relationship to define a new mobile platform beyond today's smartphones, notebooks and netbooks, enabling the development of a variety of hardware, software and mobile Internet services. Taking advantage of each company's expertise, these futuristic standards-based devices will combine the best features of the computing and communication worlds. It promises a user experience involving incredible mobile applications and always on, always connected wireless Internet access in a user-friendly pocketable form factor, say sources from the partnership.

Intel will acquire a Nokia HSPA/3G modem IP licence for use in future products. The effort includes technology development and cooperation in several open source software initiatives in order to develop common technologies for use in the Moblin and

Maemo platform projects, which will deliver Linux-based operating systems for the upcoming mobile computing devices.

The companies are coordinating their open source technology selection and development investments, including alignment on a range of key open source technologies for mobile computing such as: oFono, ConnMan, Mozilla, X.Org, BlueZ, D-BUS, Tracker, GStreamer and PulseAudio. Collectively, these technologies will provide an open source standards-based means to deliver a wealth of mobile Internet and communication experiences, with rich graphics and multimedia capabilities.

Linux Box celebrates 10th anniversary

The Linux Box, a professional services organisation specialising in open source technology, is marking its 10th anniversary by adding custom software products to its suite of services. Founded in 1999, the Ann Arbor-based company customises open source projects for blue chip clients such as McKesson, Harvard Management Company, Borders Group, FedEx and Answers.com. The Linux Box says it currently provides professional, commercial services for companies looking to gain competitive advantage, reduce IT costs and increase the control they have over their open source technologies.

"We have productised our business as a direct response to customer need," said Elizabeth Zipf, co-founder and chief executive officer, The Linux Box. "We've leveraged the intellectual capital gained over the years through client consultation and software integration in order to create custom solutions. Not only does it satisfy a need voiced by our customers, it fills a void in the marketplace."

Hello India! A FOSS campaign

Openbravo, a developer of Web-based open source ERP and Point of Sale (POS) solutions for businesses, has launched Hello India!—a campaign accommodating the growing appeal for open source software in the country. The campaign will include various initiatives, beginning with the 360° business tour, followed by Openbravo training courses, amongst others.

To kick off the Hello India! campaign, Openbravo teams will be visiting Kolkata, Hyderabad, Gurgaon, Chennai and Mumbai in August as part of its 360° Business Tour, which aims to recruit many new business partners. The event targets systems integrators, ISVs and VARs with knowledge of the mid-market ERP sector. During the tour's morning sessions, attendees will discover the growing opportunities in the open source landscape, especially with regards to implementing Openbravo's professional products.

Cees Poortman, vice president, global commercial operations, said, "Openbravo has been gaining traction in India for some time now, which has escalated to a point where we need to recruit new partners to satisfy the demand for our solutions. Any serious service company in the space should understand the benefits of partnering with the company behind the most successful open source ERP, especially in a booming market for such solutions. The 360° Business Tour is an opportunity for any company looking to either start, expand or enhance an open source business practice to realise the potential in working around Openbravo."

